

Secondary Examination, 2018

English

Time: $2\frac{1}{2}$ Hours

Maximum Marks: 80

GENERAL INSTRUCTIONS TO THE EXAMINEES:

- Then First 15 minutes is the cool-off time. You may use the time to read the questions and plan the answers.
- Read the questions carefully before answering.
- Certain sections of the questions have choice. Follow the choice regulations.
- When you select a question, all its sub questions (if any) must be answered From the same questions.

Questions 1 – 6. Read the excerpt from “The Scholarship Jacket” and answer the questions that follow. Each question carries *one* score. $1 \times 6 = 6$

We couldn't participate in sports at school because there was registration fees, uniform costs, and trips out of town; so, even though our family was quiet and athletic there would never be a school sports jacket for us. This one, the scholarship jacket, was our only chance.

In May, close to graduation, spring fever had struck as usual with a vengeance. No one paid any attention in class, instead we stared out of the windows and at each other, wanting to speed up the last wanting to speed up the last few weeks of school. I despaired every time I looked in the mirror. Pencil thin, not a curve anywhere. I was called “beanpole” and “string bean,” and I knew that's what I looked like. That really wasn't much for a fourteen-year-old to work with, I thought, as I absent-mindedly wandered from my history class to the gym....

1. Why couldn't the narrator participate in sports at school?
2. Pick out the sentences which tells us that the narrator was athletic by nature.
3. 'No one paid any attention in class, instead we stared out of the windows and at each other....' Why does the narrator say so?
4. Why did the narrator feel despair every time she looked into the mirror?
5. Find out the word from the passage which means 'the ability to move quickly.'
What were the narrator's nicknames?

Solutions:

1. The narrator could not participate in sports at school because she could not afford to pay the registration fees, uniform costs and other expenses of trips out of town.

2. The clause, “even though our family was quite agile and athletic there would never be a school sports jacket for us” tells us that the narrator was athletic by nature.
3. No student was interested in the class, everybody was in a mood of leaving the school and wanted to speed up the last few weeks as they were close to the graduation.
4. The narrator was very thin without any curve anywhere in her body.
5. The intended word is “agile”.
6. The narrator’s nick names were ‘beanpole’ and ‘string bean’.

Questions 7 to 10. Read the lines from ‘Mother to Son’ and answer the questions that follow. Each question carries *one* score. (4)

Well, son, I’ll tell you:
Life for me ain’t been no crystal stair.
It’s had tacks in it,
And splinters,
And boards torn up,
And places with no carpet on the floor—
Bare.
But all the time
I’ve been a-climbin’ on,
And reachin’ landin’s,
And turnin’ corners,
And sometimes goin’ in the dark
Where there ain’t been no light.
So boy, don’t you turn back.

7. Why is the ‘I’ referred to here?
8. What does the speaker compare her life to?
9. What is the speaker’s advice to her son?
10. What impression do you get about the speaker from these lines?

Solutions:

7. The “I” in the poem is referred to a mother who is the speaker of the poem representing the black Afro-American women.
8. The speaker compares her life to a crystal stair.
9. The speaker’s advice to her son is not to turn back even if he has to face many troubles in climbing the stairs of his life.

10. The speaker had to face many obstacles and miseries in her life. But she was very bold and determined to meet and surmount all the difficulties and was ready to work hard to succeed in life.

11. Read the following lines from the poem 'The School Boy' and attempt a brief appreciation focusing on the theme and poetic devices used. (5)

How can the bird that is born for joy,

Sit in a cage and sing.

How can a child when fears annoy,

But droop his tender wing,

And forget his youthful spring.

O! Father and Mother, if buds are nip'd,

And blossoms blown away,

And if the tender plants are strip'd

Of their joy in the springing day,

By sorrow and cares dismay,

How shall the summer arise in joy,

Or the summer fruits appear?

Solution 11:

In the above lines, the poet beautifully depicts the inner instincts of a school boy. The poet says that a bird can never sing sweet song when it is caged. In the same way, if a child remains under fear and tension, he can never enjoy the natural happiness. The poet says that if buds are nipped and tender plants are strapped, they can't grow and bloom. In the same way, the child rose in the fresh and delightful summer morning can't be happy when his parents force him to go to school where he spends his time in sorrow. The child means that when he is forced to go to school, he cannot learn anything at school. He even can't enjoy the summer and the sweetness of the season because he is forced to go to school. Here, the poet differentiates between the freedom of imagination and repression of young souls in schools. The extract follows an ababb rhyme scheme. There are rhyming words like joy-annoy, sing-wing, spring; nipped-stripped, away-day-dismay, joy-destroy, appear year. Overall the poem is delightful to read. The poet has made use of alliteration also. For example, blossoms blown, gather..... griefs, etc.

Questions 12 – 16. Read the following passage and answer the questions given. Each question carries one Score. (5)

There was a time when all house-work was done by the women or girls in the family. Few husbands never dreamt of washing up, preparing breakfast or attending the baby. Such duties were no concern of theirs. And the normal school boy assumed that if help were at home, his sisters would be called on to give it. The whole family supported the view that the male child could not or should not clean, mend, wash, cook or make beds.

Things are very different today. Doctors, barristers or managers find nothing shameful in putting on an apron to help in the kitchen or nursery and even boast of being good at washing clothes and personal linen. The school boy is more often expected to help his mother now.

One reason for the change is the shortage of domestic servants. Girls could once be found to do the hard work in middle and upper class homes. Such girls now-a-days either go to schools or work in factories. Thus, the wife now does the household work with the aid of labour saving machines, and she expects some help from her husband and children.

12. Who usually did all house work in the past?
13. Certain household work were not done by men in the past. What were they?
14. How did the whole family view the male child?
15. The writer says that things are different now. How?
16. What is the reason for the change in men's attitude towards household work?

Solutions:

12. The women or girls in the family usually did all the house-work in the past.

13. Washing up, preparing breakfast or attending babies were certain household work never done by men in the past.

14. The whole family viewed that the male child could not or should not clean, mend, wash, cook or make bed.

15. Even the male doctors, barristers or manager are now proud and boastful of working in kitchen or nursery and washing clothes and personal linen. Boys are more often expected to help their mothers now.

16. Shortage of domestic servants and unavailability of girls as they are either going to school or factories are some of the reasons that changed men's attitude towards household work.

Question 17 – 21. Given below is the list of recipients of Bhart Ratna. Study the table answer the questions that follow. Each question carries *one* Score. (5)

Year	Recipients	Field
1990	Nelson Mandela	International politics
1997	Dr. A P J Abduk Kalam	Science and Tecnology
1999	Dr. Amartya Sen	Economics
2001	Lata Mangeshkar	Music
2014	Sachin Tendulkar	Sports

17. Dr. Amartya Sen was given the Bhart Ratna for his contributions in _____
18. The payback singer who was awarded the Bhart Ratna in 2001 is _____
19. Who has been awarded the Bhart Ratna for his contributions to International Politics?
20. The sports person who was given the Bhart Ratna is _____.
21. The former President of India was awarded the Bhart Ratna for his contributions in _____.

Solutions:

17. Dr. Amartya Sen was given the Bharat Ratna for his contribution in Economics.
18. The playback singer who was awarded the Bharat Ratna in 2001 is Lata Mangeshkar.
19. Nelson Mandela has been awarded the Bharat Ratna for his contribution to International Politics.
20. The sports person who was given the Bharat Ratna is Sachin Tendulkar.
21. The former President of India was awarded the Bharat Ratna for his contribution in Science and Technology.

Questions 22 – 23 answer any ONE of the following in about 120 Words. (7)

22. According to Satyajit ray, shooting a scene with an animal is a difficult task. He narrates one such experience in ‘Project Tiger’. Prepare a **write-up**, dealing the difficulties Ray faced in shooting the scene with a tiger for the film ‘Goopy Gyne Bagha Byne’.

(Hints: Scene with a tiger- approaches Bhart Circus Company – tiger brought to the bamboo grave – difficult to control the tiger – tiger calms down – shoots the scene – too dark – retake)

Solution 22:

Format for Write-up

- A suitable Title

- Begins with sticking idea
- Ideas are presented using Specific and clear language.
- Ideas are organized well.
- Used variety of sentences
- Appropriate conclusion.

23. Mr. John's life underwent a complete change after he was rescued from his suicide attempt. Prepare a **narrative** describing the incidents in Mr. John's life.

(Hints: an orphan- looked after by his uncle- a victim of bed company – steals money from office shelf – tires to return the money – fails – suicide attempt – the landlady, the sergeant and the doctor help – becomes a charity worker)

Solution 23:

Format for Narrative:

- Proper beginning and end.
- Time and place of action.
- Organisation of ideas.
- Creativity and imagination

Questions 24 – 26. Answer any TWO of the following. Each question carries five scores. (10)

24. The Homeopath in the story "The Snake and the Mirror" was not even able to cry out, when the snake landed on his shoulder. The doctor sat like a stone image. Later, he wrote his feelings in his diary. What would the **diary entry** be? Write it.

Solution 24:

Format to write Diary entry:

- Conveys the feelings and emotions of the writer. It is a first person narrative.
- Highlights the important event/s happened on a particular day.
- Use expression and broken sentences
- Never records the routine activities.

25. The English Club of Your School has decided to prepare and stage a play based on the story "Adolf. Draft a **notice** inviting all teachers and students to watch the play.

Solution 25:

Format to write Diary entry:

- Conveys the feelings and emotions of the writer. It is a first person narrative.

- Highlights the important event/s happened on a particular day.
- Use expression and broken sentences
- Never records the routine activities.

26. Vanka writes a letter to his grandfather detailing his sufferings at the shoemaker's house. Imagine that you meet Vanka after he posted the letter. Write the **likely conversation** between Vanka and you. (Write at least five exchanges.)

Solution 26:

Points to avoid in writing conversation:

1. Avoid fillers
2. Cut Unnecessary Dialogue Tags
3. Avoid fancy Dialogue tags
4. Change the Placement of Dialogue Tags
5. Include Disagreement or Conflicts.
6. Involve Character's Desires, Goals, and Fears
7. Include Subtle Gestures and Subtext
8. Add context for atmosphere and Tone

Format of Conversation:

1. Using Right Punctuation
2. Insert Quotation Marks
3. Use Exclamation and Question Marks
4. Use Ellipses and Dashes Correctly
5. Break a long Dialogue into Short paragraphs.

Questions 27 – 31. Answer any THREE of the following. Each question carries six score. (18)

27. Write a short profile of Majid Majidi using the given details.

Born	:	April 17, 1959
Occupation	:	Film director, producer and screenwriter
Place of Birth	:	Tehran, Iran
Nationality	:	Iranian
Notable Works	:	The Colour of Paradise, The Sons of Sparrows, Children of Heaven
Awards and honours	:	Grand Pix of America Best Award in 1999

Solution 27:

Format to write Profile:

- Give a title
- Effective introduction and ending.
- Well Organised Details.
- Use of Appropriate descriptive vocabulary.
- Hints developed using supporting details.
- Use of proper linkers for connecting the ideas
- Use of appropriate language.

28. Martha was shocked when the principal informed her that the policy regarding the scholarship jacket had been changed that year. But finally she won it. Imagine that she writes a letter to her friend describing her experiences. Draft the likely **Letter**.

Solution 28:

LETTER

Uses proper format i.e. place, Date, Salutation

CONTENT:

- Good beginning
- Idea conveyed
- Proper conclusion
- Proper Complementary Close

29. 'A single story about something won't give you a clear picture of it.' Do you agree with the statement? Write a **paragraph** supporting your answer using the points from the speech 'The Danger of a Single Story'.

Solution 29:

LETTER

Uses proper format i.e. place, Date, Salutation

CONTENT:

- Good beginning
- Idea conveyed
- Proper conclusion

- Proper Complementary Close

30. Think-Tank is an amusing character in the play 'The Book that Saved the Earth'. He enjoys his power as the commander-in-chief. Attempt a **character sketch** of Think-Tank.

Solution 30:

The format to write character sketch is:

- Beginning
 - Quotation
 - Anecdote
- Remainder of First paragraph
 - Most important traits
- Following paragraphs- Supporting details!
 - What does your character look like?
 - What does the character do?
 - How does your character think?
 - How does your character speak?
- Conclusion- Your opinion
 - How do you feel about your character?

31. The story 'Vanka' hints at the troubles faced by a poor child. Your school conducts a seminar on 'the problems faced by children today' in the light of the story 'Vanka'. Prepare a **report** of the seminar focusing on the points discussed.

Solution 31:

Format for report:

- * Catchy Head line
- * Good beginning
- * Content
- * Organisation of ideas
- * Language and style
- * Uses the language of Reporting words

32. Complete the following conversation between the Doctor and his friend. (5)

Friend : You look frightened, (a)?

Doctor : Yes, I am

Friend : (b)?

Doctor : A snake fell from the roof of my room and landed on my shoulder.

Friend : Oh! ____ (c) ____?
 Doctor : No, it didn't do anything.
 Friend : What? It didn't bite you?
 Doctor : If I had moved a little, ____ (d) ____.
 Friend : Then you had better ____ (e) ____.
 Doctor : Yea, I'm thinking of finding a new house.

Solution 32:

- (a) Isn't it
- (b) Why are you so frightened ?
- (c) Did it bite you ?
- (d) it would have bitten me.
- (e) find a new house.

33. There are a few errors in the passage given below. They are underlined. Edit the passage appropriately. (4)

Ali had lost the bag in which he had kept his sister's shoes from (a) the vegetable shop. He searched the place where he has kept (b) it. He put his hands in the gap between the boxes. But he didn't **found(c)** anything. The he put his head inside the gap and the boxes fell down. The vegetables **was (d)** scattered all over the ground.

Solution 33:

- (a) in
- (b) had kept
- (c) find
- (d) were

34. Report the following dialogue. (2)

Adichie : Who made this basket?
 Fide's mother : Fide's brother has made it.
 You may begin like this:
 Adichie asked Fide's mother _____
 Fide's mother replied _____.

Solution 34:

- (a) Adichie asked Fide's mother who had made that basket.
- (b) Fide's mother replied that Fide's brother had made it.

35. Complete the following passage choosing suitable words given below: (4)

Think – Tank misinterpreted the nursery rhyme given/(a) the block. He thought/(b) the Earthlings could grow rare metals and high explosives in gardens. The Earthlings have taught their domesticated animals musical culture/(c) space techniques. He warned his team to be conscious of /(d) interplanetary attack by the Earthlings using their cows.

(that, in, if, and, the)

Solution 35:

- (a) in
- (b) that
- (c) and
- (d) the

36. Complete the following passage choosing appropriate phrasal verbs given below (3)

Adolf created some problems in our home. Our mother couldn't ____ (a) ____ it. One day Adolf (b) ____ the curtain-rod with a smash. We ____ (c) ____ our hope to tame him. Finally we decided to send him away to the wild woods.

(put up with, gave up, pulled down, take off)

Solution 36:

- (a) put up with
- (b) pulled down
- (c) gave up

37. Read the following sentences and pick out any two verb phrases from them. (2)

Vanka's grandfather had been serving the zhivarev family. He growing old.

Solution 37:

- (a) had been serving
- (b) was growing.